

Queen Elizabeth II: Toning Outfits And Wellington Boots [B2]

In occasione del centenario della nascita di Elisabetta II, ripercorriamo come la regina sia riuscita a creare un'identità visiva unica, che ha lasciato il segno nella moda britannica e nell'immaginario collettivo.

As Britain marks the centenary of Queen Elizabeth II's birth on 21 April 1926, public memory [turns not only to](#) her decades of service but also to the unmistakable visual identity she cultivated. From her earliest years as [heir](#) to the throne to her seven decades as monarch, the [late](#) Queen projected an image that was both consistent and instantly recognisable. Carefully curated and deeply symbolic, her [wardrobe](#) became part of how the world perceived her and, by association, the United Kingdom and even the Commonwealth of Nations.

A ROYAL STORY

As part of the centenary celebrations, the King's Gallery, a public art gallery at Buckingham Palace, is [hosting](#) the largest exhibition ever dedicated to her fashion sense. Entitled Queen Elizabeth II: Her Life in Style, it includes over two hundred items that, according to the Royal Collection Trust, "[chart](#) the remarkable story of Britain's longest-reigning monarch through clothing worn in all ten decades of her life: from birth to adulthood, from princess to queen, and from [off-duty](#) style to diplomatic dressing for the global stage."

ICONIC ITEMS

Among the most iconic items are the [bridesmaid](#) dress the young princess wore to her uncle's wedding in 1934; the wedding dress she wore in 1947; and the Coronation dress she wore in 1953. Also on display are "never-before-seen design sketches, [fabric](#) samples, and handwritten correspondence that reveal the behind-the-scenes process of dressing the most famous woman in the world and [shed new light on](#) the [late](#) Queen's

close involvement in the creation of her [wardrobe](#)." A [bridesmaid](#)'s dress by Edward Molyneux worn by Elizabeth II as a child in 1934 when Princess Elizabeth of York.

GOOD FOR UK FASHION

Commenting on the exhibition, its curator, Caroline de Guitaut, said, "Over the course of Queen Elizabeth II's remarkably long reign, her distinctive style became instantly recognisable around the world, [bolstering](#) the British fashion industry and influencing generations of designers and [couturiers](#)." People

The End of an Era: Elizabeth II (1926-2022)

La morte della Regina Elisabetta II rappresenta la scomparsa di un simbolo di altri tempi. La più longeva tra i regnanti della storia britannica, era, più che una semplice governante, l'incarnazione di un'istituzione che garantiva coesione e un senso di continuità per una società che si trova immersa in una crisi di identità. Conor Gleeson , Sarah Davison Hazel Clark, Professor of Design Studies and Fashion Studies at Parsons School of Design in New York City, reflects on the [late](#) Queen's uniquely British style and her enduring fashion [legacy](#). Hazel Clark: Obviously, the Queen was very [long-lived](#), and obviously she came to the throne when she was very young. But over time, she just developed a style which I always felt she seemed very comfortable in the way she looked, be it for a gala event or when she was out in Scotland in the countryside of Balmoral. I mean, she was famous for certain items, like the famous [headscarf](#), which she [fastened](#) under the [chin](#), and as well as wearing Barbour jackets, et cetera. But I think something like the [headscarf](#) from the 1950s, she carried it on way beyond it being a fashion. She became known for being what would be called 'very [put-together](#)'. She tended to favour, in [later](#) life, wearing distinctly mat[ching](#) outfits, coats and dresses, which were made in the same colour, same [fabric](#), distinctive hats, always carried her handbag, and of course, those very bright colours that she's very famous for wearing. Queen Elizabeth in 1956 wearing an evening gown designed by Norman Hartnell.

STRIKING CONTRAST

There was always a striking contrast between the Queen's formal wardrobe and what she wore in the countryside. Clark says her off-duty style reflected the life she loved away from the palace. **Hazel Clark:** She was a country woman. Obviously, the family had country estates. She rode horses, she enjoyed walking. So she was really wearing functional country wear, which was very classic in England and Scotland: Wellington boots, as they're called in the UK, rubber boots and tweeds. So it was functional clothes to keep you warm and dry.

STARK AND COORDINATED

Some of the Queen's most recognisable looks consisted of carefully-coordinated stark colours. As Hazel Clark explains, everything from her coat to her umbrella was chosen to create a consistent, instantly identifiable style. **Hazel Clark:** I think one thing that did stand out with the Queen was these toning outfits, which are obviously made specially for her. So the dress and the coat in the same colour, then the matching hat, always wore the handbag, and even the matching umbrella, the clear umbrella she carried, which had a matching colour around the rim, which would match, you know, yellow for the yellow outfit, blue for the blue, et cetera. So that sense of everything being very together, that sort of sense of coherence and consistency. And also colours that, of course, stood out because she was a petite woman and she wanted to be seen in the crowd, or from the crowd. But I think with the country items, it was very much following the classic British upper-class country clothes that they would wear for the weekend when they were hunting or shooting or fishing in the country. From April 10th to October 18th www.rct.uk/collection/exhibitions If you want to know more about this topic, read the article *The Style Of Queen Elizabeth II: Elegance And Propriety*.

Glossary

- **couturiers** = stilisti di alta moda
- **fastened** = legare, allacciare
- **chin** = mento
- **matching outfits** = completi coordinati
- **striking** = evidente, notevole
- **toning outfits** = completi in tonalità coordinate
- **petite** = minuta, di bassa statura
- **turns not only to** = rivolgersi a, ricordare
- **hosting** = ospitare, accogliere
- **bolstering** = sostenere
- **long-lived** = longeva
- **rode horses** = andare a cavallo
- **tweeds** = capi in tweed
- **rim** = bordo
- **heir** = erede
- **wardrobe** = guardaroba
- **off-duty** = fuori servizio, nel tempo libero
- **bridesmaid** = damigella d'onore
- **shed new light on** = far luce su
- **late** = defunta
- **stand out** = spiccare, risaltare
- **crowd** = folla
- **chart** = tracciare, mostrare
- **legacy** = eredità, lascito
- **headscarf** = foulard, fazzoletto per la testa
- **put-together** = curata, elegante
- **rubber** = di gomma
- **fabric** = stoffa